

Meru मेरु

A personal AI assistant that runs on your own Mac.

In some Eastern traditions, Meru is the cosmic mountain that the sun, moon and stars turn around.

v0.7.4 · November 2026 · aarora79.github.io/meru

github.com/aarora79/meru
Scan for the code

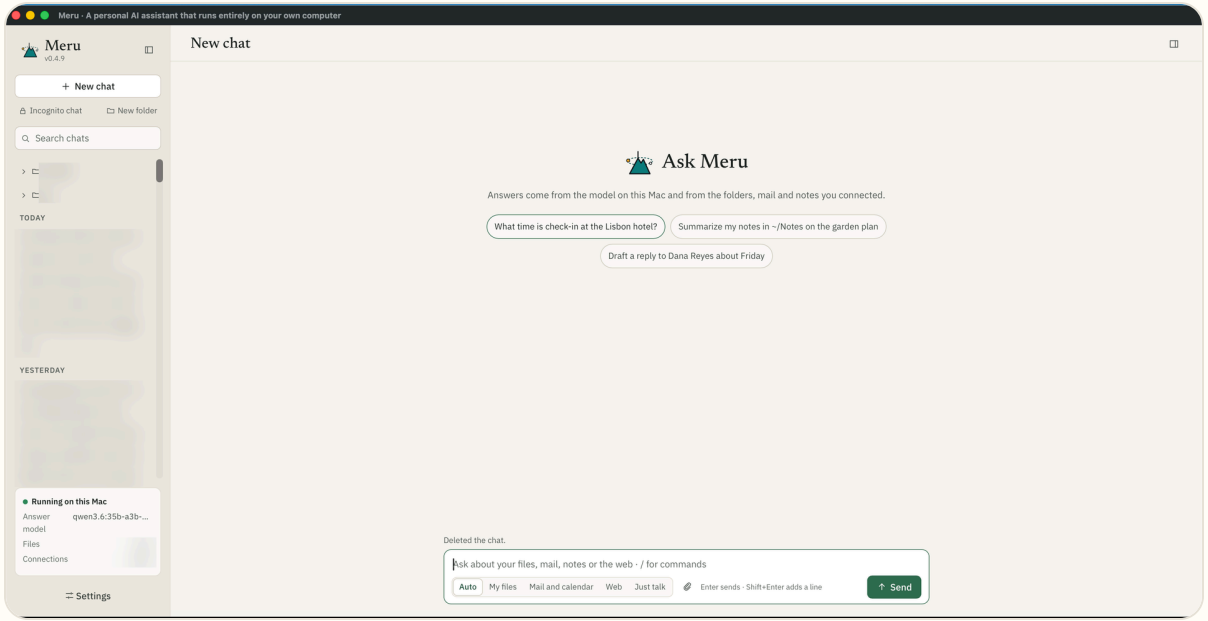
THE QUESTION

An assistant helps most with the things you'd least like to hand over

- **Your mail, notes, files and photos** are what a question like "when is the dentist?" or "what did I decide about the garden?" needs.
- **A hosted assistant reads them on its provider's servers**, under terms you don't set and that can change.
- **Meru runs on your Mac.** Open-weight models answer there, beside your data, and nothing you ask goes to a model provider.

WHAT YOU USE

Meru.app, a desktop app on your Mac



- **Ask across your own things:** folders, Gmail and Google Calendar, notes in Obsidian or Apple Notes, GitHub or Slack, and the web.
- **Attach a file or picture,** or press the microphone and speak.
- **Pick where it looks:** Auto, My files, Mail and calendar, Web, or Just talk.
- **File, tag and search** your chats, or start an incognito one.

The app talks to `merud`, a program on your Mac that runs the models through a local model server, Ollama today, and keeps your data. `meru chat` gives you the same in a terminal.

WHAT IT DOES

Questions it answers from your own things

Your files

Searches the folders you choose, Markdown, PDFs, HTML and code, and cites the file and line it used.

Your mail and calendar

Searches Gmail with its own search words and opens attachments. Reads Calendar and Drive, and asks before it sends or changes anything.

Your notes

Searches Obsidian, and reads Apple Notes live and read-only.

Your pictures

Finds pictures in your folders by words, or like one you attach, and a model that can see reads them.

The web

Searches through a search engine on your Mac, reads pages, and cites the address.

Writing

Saves notes, drafts and pages into `~/meru-output`. A card or poster you ask for carries your own photo.

IT LEARNS

An assistant that remembers who you are, in files you can read

- **Memories are Markdown files** in `~/.meru/memory/`, one per fact, in folders such as `me`, `people`, `projects` and `preferences`. What you tell it about yourself goes into every prompt.
- **You see and change them** in Settings, About you, or with `/me`; forget one with a key press, or delete the file.
- **Past chats help later ones.** Meru summarizes a chat once it goes quiet, and finds earlier chats that bear on a new question.
- **Skills** teach it how to do a task: plain writing, explainer pages, and research on the web, your files or your mail ship with it, and you can add your own.

PRIVACY

What leaves your Mac

Data	Where it goes
Your questions and Meru's answers	Nowhere: the models run on your Mac, unless you name one on your own network and say yes for that chat.
Your files, notes and pictures	Indexed into a file on your Mac and read there.
Telemetry, crash reports, update checks	One anonymous count a day, with no ID and no text, which you can turn off. No crash reports and no update checks, ever.
Web searches	The search words go to the engines your own SearXNG asks.
Web pages	Public addresses only. Meru asks first for an address no search or question of yours gave, unless you trusted that website.
Mail, calendar, GitHub, Slack	Read through your own accounts, when you connect them. A sign-in token stays in a file on your Mac only you can read.
Your voice	Turned into text on your Mac by Whisper; no recording is kept.

YOU DECIDE

You stay in charge of what it does

Before it acts

- Each tool is Off, Ask or Allow.
- Sending, deleting or changing asks you on a card, every time; you can edit the request first.
- Reading a website you didn't ask about asks too, or you trust that site for the chat or always.

After

- Every tool call is in a log you can read: `/log`, or Settings, Activity.
- Chats are plain files in `~/.meru/sessions`; delete one and it's gone.
- An incognito chat leaves no transcript.
- Meru hides your saved keys in its log and in server errors.

WHICH MAC

Answer quality and speed by Mac memory

Mac memory	Answer model	Passed	First word, median	Whole answer, median
under 32 GB	`MiniCPM5-2B`	68%	11.6 s	13.1 s
32 to 47 GB	`gemma4:26b-a4b-it-qat`	80%	17.6 s	18.3 s
48 to 63 GB	`qwen3.6:35b`	89%	5.6 s	10.4 s
64 GB or more	`qwen3.6:35b-a3b-mxfp8`	89%	4.1 s	6.5 s

The installer picks the model for your Mac's memory. 150 results per model set, 3 runs of 50 questions about the author's own files, notes, mail and calendar, which aren't published; your numbers will differ. Times include searching and tool calls. Source: docs/benchmarks/results.md, 28 September 2026.

GETTING STARTED

On your Mac in a few minutes

- **Download the Mac installer** from the latest release, open the disk image, and open "Install Meru.app". It sets up the model server and the models for your Mac, web search, the folders Meru reads, and `merud`, step by step in a window.
- **Or use one line in a terminal:** `curl -fsSL https://github.com/aarora79/meru/releases/latest/download/install.sh | bash`
- **Then connect what you want** in Settings, Connections: Google, Obsidian, Apple Notes, speech to text. Each is off until you turn it on. GitHub or Slack takes one click on Sign in.

Macs with Apple silicon. On Ubuntu, `install-linux.sh` does the same in a terminal. Web search runs in Docker or Podman. Meru never checks for updates; run the installer again for a new release, and it keeps your settings and memories.

DAY TO DAY

Small things that add up

Speak

Press the microphone, speak for up to a minute, and check the words before you send them.

Continue

An answer that stops short gets a Continue button that picks up where it stopped.

Long reading

A question can read dozens of web pages; Meru sizes the model's working memory for your Mac.

Quick replies

With routing on, the fast model takes greetings and rewording, and starts sooner. Ask the large model when you want more.

Usage

A Usage screen charts your questions, answer times and tool calls, from data on your Mac.

Jobs

Meru asks a question or runs a skill on a schedule, such as every weekday at 7, and files each run as a chat.

HOW IT COMPARES

What you get with Meru, Muse or OpenClaw

Meru

- **Private by construction.** Models run on your Mac, and no question leaves it unless you name a model on your own network and say yes.
- **No account, no subscription,** no bill per question. It works offline once the models are down.
- **Answers from your own things,** with the files cited: folders, mail, calendar, Obsidian, Apple Notes, pictures and the web.
- **Memories you can read:** one Markdown file per fact, to fix or delete.
- **Asks before it sends, deletes or changes,** logs every tool call, and flags a claimed action no tool took, or an amount nothing it read holds.
- **Your voice and pictures stay on your Mac.**

Muse, from Meta

GOOD AT

- Errands on the web: browsing, forms, bookings, payments through partners
- Meta's newest models, on phone, web and glasses

YOU GIVE UP

- Your agent and data live in Meta's cloud
- Chats train Meta's models unless you opt out
- $20 or $100 a month past the free tier; US only

OpenClaw

GOOD AT

- Reaching you in WhatsApp, Telegram, Slack and 20 more chat apps
- Any model, and broad control of your computer

YOU TAKE ON

- A hosted model sees your questions unless you run a local one
- Commands run on your computer; the sandbox is off by default
- Vetting each skill: Cisco found ones that sent data out

As of October 2026. Sources: about.fb.com/news/2026/09/introducing-muse-personal-ai-agent; en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Muse_(AI_agent); github.com/openclaw/openclaw; blogs.cisco.com/ai/personal-ai-agents-like-openclaw-are-a-security-nightmare.

HONEST LIMITS

What Meru does not do yet

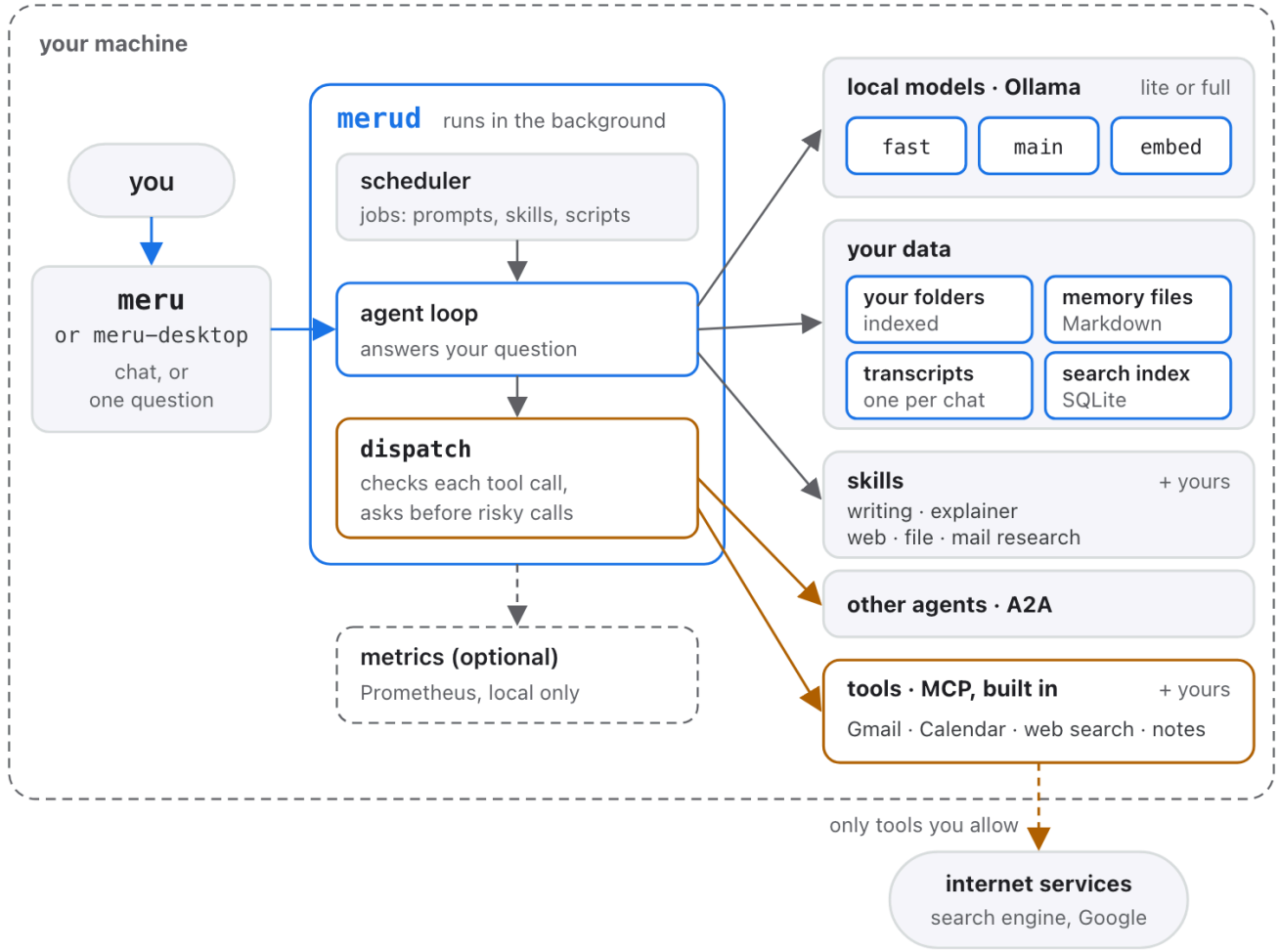
By design

- No phone app, no account, no sync between machines
- One person per machine
- No cloud model to fall back on; a larger model on your Mac or network answers only when you ask

Not yet

- Pre-alpha, v0.7.4
- Slower than a hosted assistant: the first word takes 4 to 18 seconds
- Digests and notifications are still to come
- macOS first; Ubuntu with its own installer; Windows untested

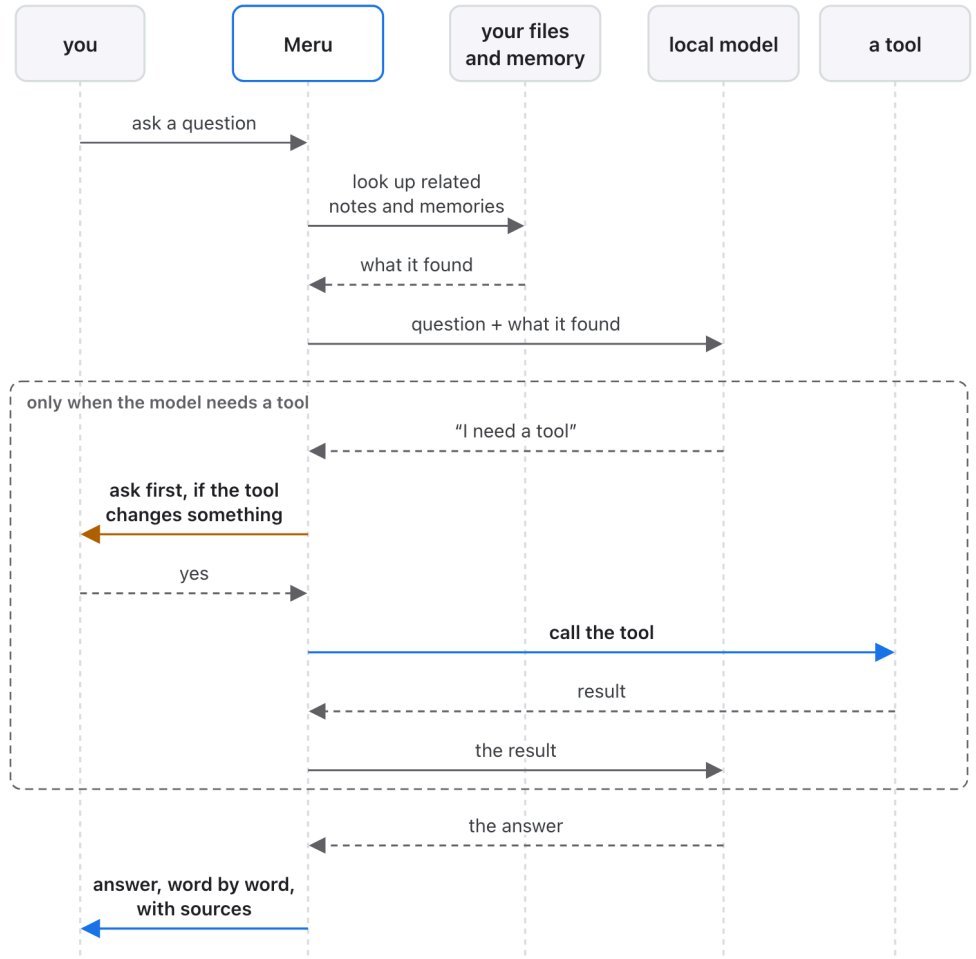
UNDER THE HOOD



Everything inside the dashed line runs on your Mac

The models, your data, the search index, your chats and memories. Only the tools you allow reach outside.

UNDER THE HOOD



What happens when you ask

- **Meru looks first** in your files and memories. A question about your own life also checks your notes and mail.
- **The model on your Mac** reads the question with what Meru found, and writes the answer.
- **The model never calls a tool itself.** It asks Meru, and Meru asks you first when the tool would send or change something.
- **The answer arrives word by word,** with the files it used. An amount nothing Meru read backs gets a note.



Built in the open

Free and open source, under the Apache License 2.0.

We're happy to take contributions: see the **issue list**. Ideas and bug reports start there too.

github.com/aarora79/meru · aarora79.github.io/meru

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